

JGB 1924**Hawkins-Stern's Impulse Buying Theory: The Egregious Impulsive Buying Behavior of Gen Z Consumers**

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Abstract

The impulse buying behavior of Generation Z (Gen Z) consumers has become imperative for researchers and businesses aiming to thrive in today's market. The egregious or shocking intuitive observation among Gen Z consumers of becoming impulsive buyers concerns the researchers. The internal and external driving forces used in the study are psychological traits, behavioral patterns, mental and emotional responses, platform, influencer impact, and purchasing power as determinants of impulsive buying drawn from Hawkins-Stern's Impulse Buying Theory. The novelty and implication will shed light from local to international perspectives to help stakeholders and companies in online business craft excellent marketing strategies and spot opportunities to attract Gen. Z consumers. A descriptive quantitative design evaluated the relationship between the variables affecting Gen Z's impulse buying behavior.

The study revealed that when emotional response and behavioral patterns, purchasing power followed by platforms is intensely used, it dramatically influences Gen Z's impulsive buyers, as justified by Hawkins-Stern's Impulse Buying Theory caused Gen Z's unplanned purchases to surpass their everyday purchases, and most likely become impulsive buyers. Driven by instinct, mood, budget, emotional response, affective state supported by past buying behavior, external stimuli, and online offerings lead to Gen Z's experiences impulsive buying to reward themselves, yet with no intent of purchasing, which leads to unplanned purchases, thus

breaking their standard buying patterns. The study failed to prove that all chosen variables greatly influence Gen Z impulsive buying behavior. Hence, future researchers are encouraged to conduct further studies.

Keywords: *Impulse Buying Behavior, Intern and External Forces, Platform, Emotional, Platform*

Introduction

Understanding the complexities of impulse buying among Gen Z has become one of the observable top strategic priorities for firms looking to thrive in the modern market. It delves into the main reasons and influential factors behind Gen Z's impulse buying behavior, shedding light on what drives their spontaneous purchasing decisions. The shocking intuitive observation that Gen Z consumers become impulsive buyers is of concern to researchers. Hence, the implication of this study from a global to local perspective can lead to greater business opportunities and marketing strategies. Many scholars and industry professionals have recently focused on understanding impulse buying, alternatively termed "impulse shopping" (Kumar et al., 2020). Impulse buying, as defined by scholars (Iyer et al., 2020; Bandyopadhyay et al., 2021; Cavazos-Arroyo & Máñez-Guaderrama, 2022; Nigam et al., 2022), refers to buying things on the spur of the moment, without planning beforehand. It involves quick decision-making and little thought about the product or its consequences, and it is not just about fulfilling immediate needs but also about expressing one's identity through the things one buys. It is about fitting into what is trending in the market, like the artisans or organic-green marketing phenomenon (Belandres & Fontanilla, 2020).

Therefore, this study's working definition of impulse buying is spontaneously purchasing products without planning, involving quick decision-making and minimal consideration. It is about satisfying immediate needs and expressing identity through product choices driven by internal and external forces. According to Halim et al. (2023), Gen Z shops differently from other generations; they trust reliable and authentic brands by searching for reviews from individuals with similar values or interests. They have become a key target for e-commerce due to their significant presence among online consumers. According to a Pew Research Center Report (2023), 32% of the world's population is Gen Z, making them a significant market segment possessing considerable purchasing power. With digital technology and social media platforms altering how people shop, it is difficult to grasp why Gen Z buys quickly with minimal consideration. Furthermore, only limited literature is available to support the researchers' curiosity on whether or not they are impulsive buyers. This prompted and motivated the researchers to fill this gap and undertake the study to address the need to explore and determine the probable reasons behind their being impulsive buyers grounded by the theory.

The research aims to explore Gen Z consumers' egregious impulsive buying behavior in Baguio City and identify the key potent factors influencing their buying decisions through rigorous intervention and analysis. This research aims to shed light on the underlying motivations that shape Gen Z's purchase intention through the crafted and chosen indicators. Hence, this will serve as the study's novel, which the researcher believes to be a relevant factor influencing consumer buying behavior when making buying decisions.

To address the objectives, an attempt to explore and provide answers to the following questions:

1. What determines the internal driving forces for Gen Z's becoming an impulsive buyer?
 - a. Psychological traits
 - b. Behavioral patterns
 - c. Mental response
 - d. Emotional response
2. What determines the external driving forces for Gen z's becoming an impulsive buyer in terms of;
 - a. Platform
 - b. Influencer impact
 - c. Purchasing power
3. Which of those motivating factors is the most effective force influencing Gen Z's impulsive buying behavior?

Hawkins-Stern's Impulsive Buying Theory

The theoretical underpinning of the study is grounded by the theory of Hawkins-Stern's Impulsive Buying Theory proposed in 1962 by Hawkins. He believed in impulse behavior and argued that consumers indulge in impulsive buying behavior under the influence of external forces and examples such as promotions, advertising, and word of mouth. Stern created four categories of impulse buying as stated by Sajeetha-Madhavan & Tay, L. (2023), namely: *Pure Impulse Buying* is experienced when there *is* an escape purchase that breaks the regular buying pattern and occurs when a customer sees a product or remembers an advertisement. *Reminder: Impulse Buying* is when the consumer has no intention of buying it but remembers that they need it, which eventually leads to unplanned purchases. A study by Barcelona et al. (2022) states that

Pure Impulse and Suggested Impulse Buying habits are experienced only with little impact by TikTok's Shopee finds. This is further explained by the respondents' planned impulse buying and reminder impulse buying habits. The next category is *Suggested Impulse Buying*, which occurs when a consumer first sees a product and feels a need for it, then buys it. Finally, *Planned Impulse Buying* happens when the consumer makes a specific purchase decision based on special prices, coupon offerings, visuals, promotional offers, and lower prices that lead to impulse buying and are driven by their mood swing (mental and emotional state). The study conducted by Sajeetha-Madhavan and Tay (2023) stated that online impulse-buying behavior has a favorable relationship with price, promotion, motivation, service quality, variety, and convenience. Similarly, Ng, J. Q. (2023) explained that external factors like free shipping promotions and quality of service attracted consumers to impulse buying, especially during the festival season.

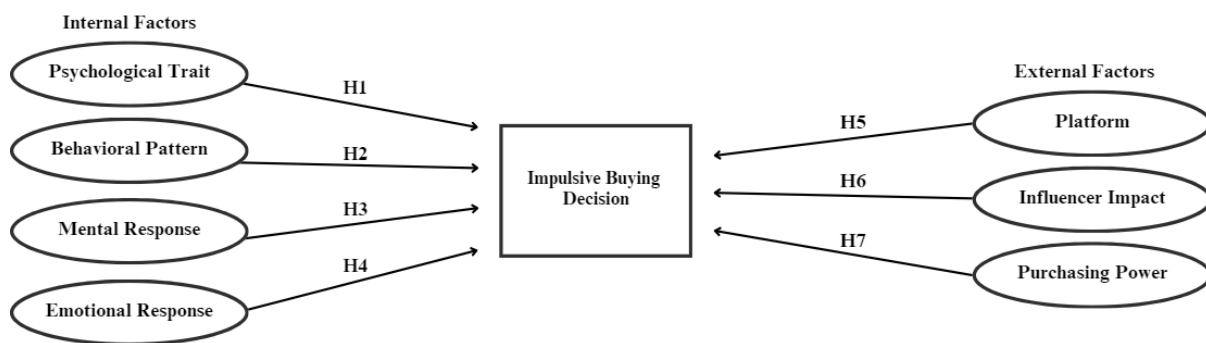


Figure 1. *Conceptual Framework*

The internal driving forces in this study are factors that influence the buyer's instinct and stimulus response: The psychological traits, behavioral patterns, and mental and emotional responses that influence Gen Z consumers to become impulsive buyers. Halim et al. (2023) state that brand image, price, mental budgeting, and self-control affect Gen Z's impulsive purchasing behavior. Furthermore, external forces such as platforms, influencers, and

purchasing power are beyond the inner stimuli of the buyer, which are coming from outside sources that also influence the buying decisions of Gen Z consumers. For example, social validation or influence (Deshuai & You, 2022) and social media (Mijoska (2023)). Therefore, the hypothesized relationships are tested in the empirical study as follows.

H1: Psychological traits are a driving force significantly influencing impulsive buying decisions.

Psychological traits (personality traits, attitudes, and motivations) are hypothesized to influence Gen Z's impulsive buying decisions positively. Moreover, according to Vadavadagi (2022), consumers are most likely to engage in spontaneous purchases when they have developed a deeper emotional connection with the brand through customer satisfaction. Mesquita (2024) and Yadav & Sharma (2022) highlighted that self-gift giving often serves therapeutic purposes, helping consumers cope with stress and celebrate personal achievements. However, Rozman and Hashim (2023) mentioned that peer influence significantly shapes consumer behavior. Therefore, Gen Z's purchase intentions and motivation can lead to becoming impulsive buyers.

H2: Behavioral patterns are a driving force strongly related to influencing impulsive buying decisions.

Behavioral driving forces (such as external cues, past buying behavior, external stimuli, and situational factors) are hypothesized to positively and significantly influence Gen Z's impulsive buying decisions. As Yasin, Julita, and Hidayat (2023) mentioned, lifestyle significantly affects purchase decisions, and emotional aspects impact impulsive purchase decisions (Muhammad, Adeshola, Isiaku, 2023). According to Yadav & Sharma (2022) and Vadavadagi (2022), consumers who experience positive emotions exhibit less impulsive behavior, and consumers who experience negative emotions exhibit more impulsive behavior.

Hussain et al. (2024) explained that satisfied consumers will likely engage in repeat impulse buying to relive the gratifying experiences. Thus, the notion of Gen Z is behaviorally inclined towards being an impulsive buyer.

H3: Mental response driving force is strongly related to influencing impulsive buying decisions.

Mental response driving forces (such as cognitive processes, decision-making styles, information processing, and cognitive mechanisms) are hypothesized to influence Gen Z's impulsive buying decisions positively. Li, Hou, and Ali (2022) state that cognitive attitude positively predicts Generation Z consumers' online impulsive buying behavior. Dinh and Lee (2021) suggested that imitating influencers strongly influences social comparison, which is reflected in the fear of missing out (FOMO) effect, ultimately impacting the intention to purchase the endorsed product. However, as for Deshuai and You (2022), social validation is essential in guiding the purchasing decisions of younger shoppers. Thus, mental processing of information is necessary before buying; however, sometimes, they do not, leading to the quick decision to buy.

H4: Emotional response driving force is significantly related to influence impulsive buying decisions.

Emotional response driving forces (mood, stimuli, emotional and affective states) are hypothesized to influence Gen Z's impulsive buying behavior positively. It is proposed that emotion triggers and dramatically influences the impulsive buying of Gen Z consumers, with certain levels of emotions leading to extreme impulsivity in purchasing behavior. Li, Hou & Ali (2022) state that affective attitude positively predicts Generation Z consumers' online impulsive buying behavior. Yadav & Sharma (2022) and Rodrigues et al. (2021) also explained that strong emotional desires for immediate gratification drive impulse purchases. Thus, as a young

generation, Gen Z may experience a state of mood that triggers stimuli to buy something abruptly.

H5: Platform is strongly related to influencing impulsive buying decisions.

Platforms, as digital online avenues to shop, are hypothesized to play a significant role in stimulating impulse buying behavior. The accessibility, convenience, and enticing deals (discounts, promos, price discounts) offered through online platforms create a sense of urgency among consumers, leading to impulsive purchasing decisions. Yasin, Julita, and Hidayat (2023) and Mijoska (2023) mentioned that social media significantly affects purchase decisions. Aesthetic appeal, scarcity promotions, and discounted prices stimulate impulse buying behavior in Gen-Z (Muhammad, Adeshola, Isiaku, 2023). Price discounts and a sense of pleasure and pleasure will positively and significantly affect impulsive buying Rashid (2023). The study of Sjahruddin & Adif (2024) states that the platform plays a significant role in influencing and shaping consumer behavior, but for Singh, Sharma, Arora, and Bhatt (2023), the platform does not significantly influence impulse buying behavior. Furthermore, Lou and Yuan (2019) highlight that message value and influencer credibility on social media positively impact consumer trust and purchase intentions, which is increasingly relevant in understanding Gen Z's buying behavior and creating parasocial interactions leading to impulse purchases (Mardhiana, 2024).

H6: Influencer impact is strongly related to influencing impulsive buying decisions.

Social media influencers and peer groups strongly influence impulsive buying habits with their authority and rapport, trend-driven purchases, especially among Gen Z. Similarly, peer influence extends to interactions with salespeople, shaping impulsive buying decisions.

Additionally, Shan, Chen, and Lin (2019) found that brand endorsements are more effective

when influencers align with a consumer's values, especially when consumers believe the influencer has genuine motives. Deshuai and You (2022) highlight that social validation is key in shaping younger consumers' purchasing behavior. Thus, Gen Z tends to make impulsive purchases when they receive positive peer feedback and demonstrate authenticity and transparency, strengthening their connection to the brand. For Torres et al. (2019) and Shan, Chen, and Lin (2019), the digital influencer's attractiveness influences brand attitudes and purchase intentions. However, for Halim et al. (2023), it is more of brand image, price, mental budgeting, and self-control.

H7: Purchasing Power is strongly related to influencing the impulsive buying decision.

It explains that Gen Z consumers' impulse buying behavior is influenced by their purchasing power, encompassing factors such as disposable income, access to credit, and payment preferences; the emphasis on pricing indicates that Gen Z is still mindful of expenses and their capacity to pay. The value of budgeting helps to mitigate their impulsive buying habits. For Berman & Israeli (2022), the spending habits among young consumers, overspending and accumulating debt (Fook & McNeill, 2020), and Sales promo, as stated by Miao, Jalees, Qabool, & Zama (2020), are important considerations for purchasing online. Thus, Gen Z's capacity to pay may lead them to be an impulsive buyer because they have enough budget they have enough budget to support their wants and needs.

Significance of the Study

This research study offers valuable insights for business owners to optimize marketing strategies, enabling tailored approaches to capture Gen Z's attention and foster loyalty. Thisrketers to imarketersate in product development and communication strategies, aligning with Gen Z's values for long-term engagement. For students, this study will provide practical

insights into consumer psychology, enhancing their self-concept and avoiding the negative impact of being an impulse buyer. The educators can utilize the findings to enrich classroom discussions, exercises, and case studies. Vloggers can leverage insights from the study to tailor the content of their marketing strategies, maximizing engagement and monetization opportunities among Gen Z viewers. Future researchers can build upon this foundation, exploring nuanced aspects of Gen Z's impulse buying behavior in the digital age, thus contributing to ongoing discourse on consumer trends and preferences. Lastly, for impulse buyers, it will help them discover the unknown reasons that trigger impulsive buying, develop self-control strategies, avoid regrettable purchases, improve financial planning, manage time more effectively, and slow down their purchasing habits.

Methodology

Research Design

The research employs a descriptive quantitative design to evaluate the relationship between the variables affecting impulse buyers of Gen Z. The research focused on identifying the connections between internal and external factors and impulse-buying decisions. A self-administered questionnaire was developed using a 5-point Likert scale to measure participants' agreement with statements related to their buying habits. The structured questionnaire is composed of four parts. The first part is the demographic profile, and the second to last part is the questions addressed to the three objectives. This method allowed the researcher to understand the underlying forces shaping impulsive buying behavior.

Population and Locale of the Study

The population for this research comprises Generation Z individuals aged 12 to 27 years old; however, only 18 are respondents (born between 1997 and 2007, not 2012) residing and or

studying in Baguio City, Philippines, excluding minors. They were selected for their significant engagement in online purchases and susceptibility to impulsive buying behaviors influenced by digital marketing trends such as online shopping. Baguio City is a prominent urban center and tourist destination in the northern Philippines, which features a diverse online retail outlet and near-dropping stations relevant to examining impulse buying behaviors.

Data Gathering Instrument

The researchers developed a structured survey questionnaire organized into several parts to answer the research objectives and to facilitate comprehensive data collection on impulse buying behavior among Generation Z. The questionnaire underwent a rigorous validation process, including assessments by three expert professionals in the field. One came from the academe, a marketing specialist, and social media influencers to ensure the content relevance and clarity of the questionnaire. The instrument's validity was evaluated using Aiken's V. Following the suggested modifications; the questionnaire was systematically updated and revised to ensure alignment with the research objectives.

The researcher used Slovin's formula to compute the sample size of the respondents from a 1,000 total population. The researcher conducted a pilot test involving 15 respondents to evaluate the effectiveness and reliability of the questionnaire. Reliability was tested using Cronbach's alpha to confirm internal consistency. The reliability test was conducted using SPSS Version 23, a statistical measure to assess the internal consistency and reliability of the instrument. The pre-test results showed a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.96, indicating excellent reliability, meaning the test items are highly integrated in measuring the intended concept. Because of the test item's high level of dependability, measurement error is decreased because consistent findings are obtained. This thorough validation and pre-test process ensures the

accuracy and reliability of the questionnaire to be used in gathering the necessary data from the respondents.

Data Gathering Procedure

Considering the limited running time of the distribution of questionnaires, the researcher decided to create Google Forms (GForms) to facilitate a massive number of respondents. The GForms were then shared in the different group chats of students, and they were encouraged to do the same to their respective groups or peers to expedite the completion of data gathering. The respondents were informed of their voluntary participation and strict compliance with data privacy and that the data would be treated with high confidentiality. Among the Gen Z respondents, only those aged 18 and above are chosen to respond to the survey since minors need parental consent. Hence, they are not included as respondents. Throughout the research journey, ethics standards are highly observed and practiced as set by the university's ethics committee. 419 respondents actively participated in face-to-face and GForms surveys for two weeks. The data gathered were summarized and submitted for statistical treatment. Each part of the questionnaire was tabulated using the SPSS Version 23.

Results and Discussion

To answer all the objectives and the research hypothesis, the data collected from the respondents were analyzed using the summary of variables indicated in the following tables. It summarizes the factors that significantly influence impulsive buying behavior. The findings are discussed the study's objectives and relevant literature to corroborate the findings from the detailed respondents' demographic profile, indicators, and key driving forces behind their impulsive buying decisions. *(Please refer to appendices for complete results of tables)*

Table 1*Summary of Internal Factors*

Indicators	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
Psychological Traits	3.27	Somewhat Agree
Behavioral Patterns	3.51	Agree
Mental Response	3.20	Somewhat Agree
Emotional Response	3.53	Agree
Average Weighted Mean	3.38	Somewhat Agree

Table 1 summarizes the results of internal factors influencing Gen Z's impulse buying behavior. This table revealed that the major contributory internal factor influencing Generation Z's impulse buying behavior as they engage in buying decisions is highly influenced by emotional response and behavioral patterns, resulting in 3.53 and 3.51 equivalent to agreement, respectively. These variables greatly influenced Gen Z to exercise impulse buying. However, with psychological traits and mental response, a somewhat agreed equivalent result means a moderate influence on impulsive buying. Therefore, hypotheses 2 and 4 accept that behavioral patterns and emotional responses greatly affect impulse buying because emotions can easily persuade a person to indulge in shopping suddenly (Hussain et al., 2024). On the other hand, hypotheses 1 and 3 are rejected. Psychological traits and mental responses are not strongly related to influence impulsive buying behavior.

Driven by their mood (stress, anxiety, boredom, self-reward, happiness, sadness), they drive Gen Z to make unplanned decisions at a moderate level. Similar to the findings of Kumar et al. (2020), emotional responses and affective states supported by past buying behavior, stimuli, and situational factors explain Gen Z's becoming impulsive buyers. This is true when consumers are actively involved in observing the trends in the market like green marketing (Belandres & Fontanilla, 2020), Personal values (Chen & Lin, 2019), positive emotions (Yadav

& Sharma, 2022), self-gift or reward (Mesquita, 2024) is; (Lerio & Borje, 2024), Gen Z consumers emotional response are more likely to engage in spontaneous purchase in the future and have developed a deeper emotional connection with the brand as confirmed by Vadavadagi (2022). However, emotional responses revealed that Gen Z's negative emotions directly lead to impulse buying, which contradicts the findings of Yadav & Sharma (2022) and do not directly affect consumers' impulse buyers. Positive emotions by Rodrigues et al. (2021) driven by intense emotional desire may lead to immediate gratification, showing less impulsive buying behavior and leading to more rational decisions. On the contrary, the result does not align with the study of Lee et al. (2019) and Rozman and Hashim (2023), which state that peer influence significantly affects impulse buying behavior. Thus, while personal experiences play a crucial role, social context may not have the same level of influence on every consumer. However, for Deshuai and You (2022) and Yade and Indrawati (2024), social validation is essential in guiding the impulsive buying decisions of younger shoppers, which is contradictory to the result of this study.

Proven by Hawkins-Stern's Impulsive Buying Theory, which implies that Planned impulse buying, Reminder impulse buying, Pure impulse buying, and Suggested impulse buying happen when consumers make specific decisions and rely strongly on experience when making decisions is aligned with the study of Yadav & Sharma (2022); Vadavadagi (2022).

Furthermore, persuasive advertisements, coupon offerings, and promotional sales may be difficult to resist when making purchases, thus making unplanned purchases. Even if they have no intention of buying, they first see a product and feel a need or want for it, and remember that they wanted or needed the products, leading to unplanned purchases, breaking their regular buying pattern as consumers, and becoming impulsive buyers. A higher percentage of females,

followed by males, are more sensitive to online promotions, such as price drops, which may attract their emotions to shop online (Sajeetha-Madhavan & Tay, 2023).

Finally, the result indicates that mental response (FOMO on trends, hard time resisting unnecessary purchases and even feeling guilty about purchases) and psychological traits (boredom, personal expression of self, buying wants, not needs) can influence impulsive buying behavior but with little reserve. Gen Z need not buy items just to fit in with a circle of friends or peers but more of a reward.

Table 2.

Summary of External Factors

Indicators	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
Platform	3.40	Agree
Purchasing Power	3.47	Agree
Influencer Impact	3.32	Somewhat Agree
Average Weighted Mean	3.40	Agree

Table 2 summarizes external factors that significantly influence the impulsive buying of Gen Z: the buyers' purchasing power and their choice of platform to shop. Consumers may access internet services 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, from any place, which might explain this finding by (Hou et al., 2022)—followed by influencer impact not far from being an influential factor. That is why firms need to understand how endorsers/influencers can influence emotions that influence young people's purchase preferences (Chiu et al., 2020). Hypothesis 6 is rejected—the result is Somewhat Agree at 3.32, whereas Hypothesis 5 and 7 at 3.40 and 3.47 are accepted, and the result is Agree. Based on the profile of the respondents who buy online about 3 to 5 times a month, aged from 18 to 24 years old, the majority of them were female respondents, engaged in Lazada online shopping, Facebook marketplace platform, and limited

stock items promo greatly influence their impulse buying behavior. This finding is aligned with the result of Sjahruddin & Adif (2024) and Mardhiana (2024) that platforms affect consumers to become impulse buyers; however, it contradicts the result of the findings of Singh, Sharma, Arora, & Bhatt (2023) that platforms do not significantly influence impulse buying behavior. Hawkins-Stern's Impulsive Buying Theory elaborates that consumers indulge in impulsive buying behavior under the influence of external forces such as media platforms, promotions, advertising, and word of mouth. Influencer impact (endorser and favorite influencer) at moderate impact, brand attributes, and purchase intentions (Torres et al., 2019) are influenced by digital influences attractiveness and informative content (Lou & Yuan, 2019), brand endorsement (Shan, Chen, & Lin, 2019) may not strongly influence Gen Z to spontaneous impulse buying.

Contrary to the previous findings, Gen Z placed greater value on the credibility of both influencers and social circles when making purchases. Price (Hali et al., 2023), brand image, mental budgeting, and self-control can influence impulsive buying. Similarly, the results of this study indicate that price plays an important role in placing online orders (Fook & McNeil, 2020; Berman & Israel, 2022; Miao, Jalees, Qabool, & Zama, 2020).

The most effective forces that influenced the impulsive buying behavior of Gen Z are: Behavioral pattern, emotional response, platform, and purchasing power. Thereby, Gen Z's behavior and experience as impulsive buyers are explained through the four categories of impulse buying: Pure Impulsive Buying, Reminder Impulsive Buying, Suggested Impulsive Buying, and Planned Impulsive Buying as justification for their being impulsive buyers. This could be an avenue to improve the business's marketing and business strategy to sell permits.

Thereby, Gen Z is a good target market because they tend to be an impulsive buyer exercising aggressiveness in their buying intentions.

Scope and Limitation

This study delves into the impulse buying habits of Gen Z consumers using social media and tangible consumer goods, thus emphasizing digital platforms' impact on shaping Gen Z's purchasing habits as impulsive buyers. Services and physical stores are avenues for future researchers to explore more about the impulsive buying behavior of consumers and other categories of products and variables. In order to accomplish its goals, the study operates within a time constraint of five months (the effect of typhoons and cancelation of classes and special events distract the gathering of data) to expedite the use of Gform aside from face-to-face, considering the timeline of the academic year. In this study, researchers will focus solely on four social media platforms: TikTok Shop, Facebook Marketplace, Shopee, and Lazada. These platforms were chosen for their prominence in online shopping and relevance to consumer behavior.

Conclusions and Recommendation

The egregious result of thorough analysis using the given factors significantly influences Gen Z consumers to become impulse buyers. It is concluded that Gen Z is highly prone to becoming impulsive buyers, as explained by Hawkins-Stern's Impulsive Buying Theory. Thus, it can be supported by internal and external driving forces that play an important role in driving them to become impulsive in their buying decision. Additionally, this sustained study helps us realize how these indicators may shape Gen Z's overall reason for being an impulsive buyer.

Therefore, the overall reason why Gen Z's make impulsive purchases is to reward themselves, whereas Gen Z's treat themselves for many satisfying reasons, which leads them to

become impulse buyers. Furthermore, relying on experience with the product greatly influences being an impulsive buyer. This happens when they encounter a positive experience with the product, like a good quality product that makes them trust the brand and leads to customer loyalty. On the other hand, positive comments and reviews from others are also a key factor in being impulsive because they also want to experience the same positive result.

Moreover, in terms of the external factor, purchasing power, their budget to pay the price of the product is an essential factor for Gen Z. Price serves as the primary motivator of their willingness to buy matched with the available budget that will trigger them to engage in impulse buying decisions to satisfy their needs and wants. Platform also significantly influences the impulse buying behavior of Generation Z consumers but with little reservation for consumers when making convenient and quick purchase decisions. The findings show that Gen Z is more convenient to buy online because of the smooth transaction and experience offered by these online shopping platforms. Thereafter, the remaining variables are contributory factors but with little reservation in influencing Gen Z to become impulsive buyers.

Generation Z's egregious or excessive tendency to make spontaneous purchases, influenced by various internal and external elements, could prompt more in-depth research to uncover the intricate reasons that drive them to buy on impulse. The findings from this study will add to existing knowledge, assisting business owners and other stakeholders in managing impulsive shoppers and ultimately creating greater influence and opportunities within the Gen Z market.

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Appendices

Appendix A: Respondent Profile Variables

Profile	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Gender	Female	258	61.58%
	Male	142	33.89%
	Prefer not to say	19	4.53%
Age	18-24	412	97.33%
	25-27	7	1.67%
Unplanned Purchases	0-2 times	89	21.24%
	3-5 times	178	42.28%
	6-8 times	55	13.13%
	More than 8 times	97	23.15%
Monthly Spending Budget	Below PHP 10,000	177	42.24%
	PHP 10,001-PHP 25,000	137	32.70%
	PHP25,001-PHP 50,000	61	14.56%
	PHP 50,001 and Above	44	10.50%

Appendix B:

Psychological Traits	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I feel that purchasing products is a way to reward myself.	4.16	Agree
I make unplanned purchases when I see a product that caught my attention.	3.79	Agree
I buy things to express my individuality.	3.57	Agree
I find myself making purchases when I am under stress.	3.32	Somewhat Agree
I make purchases to relieve boredom.	3.13	Somewhat Agree
I buy things even if I do not need them.	3.11	Somewhat Agree
I make purchases when I have low self-esteem.	2.84	Somewhat Agree
I purchase items because I want to fit in with my friends or peers.	2.26	Disagree
Weighted Average	3.27	Somewhat Agree

Behavioral Patterns	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I rely on my past experiences with the product when making purchases.	4.24	Strongly Agree
I make unplanned purchases if I have an immediate need.	4.01	Agree
The best time for me to make an unplanned purchase is during my free time.	3.74	Agree
I make purchases when the buying process is easy and convenient.	3.72	Agree
I am persuaded to buy if I encounter a limited-time offer or sale.	3.63	Agree
I make purchases when I'm influenced by persuasive advertising.	3.35	Somewhat Agree
I am more inclined to buy a product that is new to me.	3.07	Somewhat Agree
I make purchases because I can't resist temptation.	3.03	Somewhat Agree
I make unplanned purchases when I notice others buying similar items.	2.76	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.51	Agree

Mental Response	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I make purchases when I see positive comments and reviews from others.	4.01	Agree
I would rather consider all possibilities carefully before making a purchase of items I don't actually need.	3.98	Agree
Basic product information increases my likelihood of making purchases.	3.58	Agree
I feel a sense of guilt or remorse after making purchases.	3.20	Somewhat Agree
I am having a hard time resisting the need to purchase unnecessary items.	3.00	Somewhat Agree
I buy products due to a fear of missing out (FOMO) on popular trends or limited-edition items.	2.42	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.20	Somewhat Agree

Emotional Response	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I am more likely to make a purchase if I want to reward or treat myself.	4.10	Agree
I feel satisfied and happy immediately after making a purchase.	4.01	Agree
I make purchases when I'm in a good mood.	3.69	Agree
Feeling happy or excited has no impact on my tendency to make spontaneous purchases.	3.34	Somewhat Agree
I am positively driven by my emotions that lead me to abrupt purchase.	3.25	Somewhat Agree
I am motivated to purchase, as it is my coping mechanism for my negative emotion.	3.24	Somewhat Agree
I make unplanned purchases when I feel bored or lonely.	3.06	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.53	Agree

Influencer Impact	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I verify the influencer's credibility before making a purchase.	3.77	Agree
I believe my family's reviews about a product.	3.76	Agree
I believe my friends' reviews about a product.	3.73	Agree
I buy products if my favorite influencer promotes something.	2.87	Somewhat Agree
I am influenced to buy random products when popular influencers endorse them.	2.83	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.32	Somewhat Agree

Platform	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I find online shopping platforms (e.g., TikTok, Shopee, Lazada, and Facebook Marketplace) convenient for making quick purchase decisions.	4.03	Agree
I prefer to shop using Shopee when purchasing online.	3.70	Agree
The responsiveness and speed of online shopping platforms influence me to buy.	3.61	Agree
I prefer to shop using TikTok when purchasing online.	3.56	Agree
I trust the security measures (e.g., secure payment gateways, data encryption) implemented by online shopping platforms.	3.54	Agree
The simple interface and user-friendliness of the online shopping platforms influences me to buy immediately.	3.46	Agree
I am motivated to buy when someone recommends an online shopping platform.	3.40	Agree
I make an impulse purchase when an online product has limited stock.	3.27	Somewhat Agree
I prefer to shop using Lazada when purchasing online.	2.81	Somewhat Agree
I prefer to shop using Facebook Marketplace when purchasing online.	2.58	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.40	Agree

Purchasing Power	Weighted Mean	Descriptive Equivalent
I consider the price of the product before purchasing it.	4.28	Strongly Agree
I consider my monthly budget when purchasing a product.	4.12	Agree
I spend more when using payment methods that offer rewards or vouchers.	3.77	Agree
I use Digital Wallets (e.g., GCash, Maya, PayMaya, GrabPay) as my preferred payment method when making purchases.	3.70	Agree
I use Cash as my preferred payment method when making purchases.	3.65	Agree
I have difficulty organizing my spending according to my budget.	3.40	Somewhat Agree
I use Bank Transfer (e.g., Bank to Bank) as my preferred payment method when making purchases.	2.85	Somewhat Agree
I use Credit Cards (e.g., BDO, BPI, Metrobank, and international providers) as my preferred payment method when making purchases.	2.78	Somewhat Agree
I find the Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) feature of shopping apps convenient.	2.65	Somewhat Agree
Weighted Average	3.47	Agree